

Canada's Population Trends

Student Activity Sheets

Name: _____

****Most of the answers to these questions can be found in the Canada's Population Trends background section.***

- 1) Table 1 in Canada's Population Trends Background Information shows the wide spectrum of population densities across the ecozones for CENSUS years 1971, 1976, 1981, 1986, and 1991. From this Table, answer the following questions:

- A. Which ecozone has the highest density? _____
 B. Which have the lowest? _____
 C. Can you explain why there is a great difference between the ecozone, which has the highest density, and the one with the lowest?

- D. Find an ecozone where the population trend is to increase. _____

- E. Find one, which is decreasing. _____

- F. Find one, which is relatively constant. _____

- G. Can you think of reasons why?

- 2) Calculate the population density, i.e. the number of people per square kilometer, for 1996.
 This is calculated by dividing the population of each ecozone by its area in square kilometers.

Table 2: Population density for 1996

Ecozone Names	Land Area (km ²)	Population 1996	No. of dwellings 1996	Density (pop./area)	No. persons/dwelling
Arctic Cordillera	236309	1196	266		
Northern Arctic	1338353	18881	4825		
Southern Arctic	645355	11729	2892		
Taiga Plains	549116	23986	7632		
Taiga Shield	1077604	36560	10565		
Boreal Shield	1620871	2894961	1082951		
Atlantic Maritime	196691	2549061	963871		
Mixedwood Plains	109779	14840411	5626811		
Boreal Plains	664274	745172	259095		
Prairies	454046	3979522	1499905		
Taiga Cordillera	260373	358	128		
Boreal Cordillera	450921	30324	11386		
Pacific Maritime	201670	2848289	1098179		
Montane Cordillera	471117	851656	326977		
Hudson Plains	346016	11811	2902		

3) Are the ecozones with the highest population also the ones with the highest density? Why?

4) Let's use a ratio to find the average number of people in each dwelling. This will be calculated by dividing the population by the number of dwellings to give us the number of persons/dwelling in each ecozone.

A. Which ecozones do you think have the highest number of persons in a single dwelling? Do the calculation and see if you are right.

B. Is this what you expected? Can you think of reasons why?

5) Compare the population density for 1996 you have obtain in Table 2 above to the Density Table in the Background Information (Table 1) for CENSUS years 1971 – 1991.

A. Are the trends you found in years 1971 through 1991 continuing into 1996?

B. Are there any changes in the population trend of the ecozones between 1991 and 1996?

C. Why would the population densities for the ecozones be much lower than that of a city? See Table 3 in the Background Information to obtain examples of city densities.

6) Now let's examine Table 3: CENSUS for Major Metropolitan Areas and Populations for Canada from the Background Information more closely.

A. Which city has the greatest population? _____

B. Which city has the greatest area? _____

C. Which city has the highest density? _____

D. Which city has the smallest population? _____

E. Which city has the smallest area? _____

F. Which city has the lowest density? _____

G. Are there some surprises as to what you would expect?

H. Can you explain why Charlottetown would have approximately the same density as Toronto?

- 7) Do the ArcView lesson or use an atlas to find five communities in ecozones different from your own. Try using a theme such as; communities farthest from your own, or in ecozones adjacent to yours.
- 8) Find the Statistics Canada web site at www.statcan.ca. Look up *CENSUS / The Structural Profile of Canadian Communities*. Fill in the chart below with the information for your community or city as well as a community or city from each of four ecozones different from your own. How do they compare? Give a name to your table.

Table 4:

Item	Your location	Location 2	Location 3	Location 4	Location 5
ecozone					
community					
land area					
population					
population 1996					
population 1991					
pop. change					
avg. age					
# aboriginals					
Education					
% males with greater than high school education					
% females with greater than high school education					
Income and work					
avg. male income					
avg. female income					
male unemployment rate					
female unemployment rate					
Family and income					
avg. value owned occupied dwelling					
Births & deaths					
# of Births					
# of Deaths					

- 9) Now, let's use some of these figures to produce our own statistics in the table below.
- Calculate the population density for these five communities.
 - Calculate the percentage of aboriginals in each community in 1996.
 - Determine the ratio of males to females with high school education (Divide the number of males by number of females).
 - Determine the natural increase rate by subtracting the number of deaths from the number of births.
 - Give a name to your table.

Table 5:

Item	Your location	Location 2	Location 3	Location 4	Location 5
Ecozone					
Community					
population density 1996					
% of population that are aboriginal					
ratio M/F with high school diploma					
natural increase rate					

10) How does your community compare with the others?
